



Home > IT Services (Knowledge Base) > Network & Phones > VPN >

Configure VPN Client on your Computer, Tablet, or Phone



KB0020109

Configure VPN Client on your Computer, Tablet, or Phone

📅 6d ago • 👁 174549 Views • ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Overview

Download and configure the UCSD Virtual Private Network (VPN) Cisco Secure Client on your computer, phone, or tablet. If you would like more information about the campus VPN, see the [Virtual Private Networks \(VPN\) at UCSD page](#).

See the steps for your operating system:

- [Windows 11 / 10](#)
- [Mac OS X](#)
- [Android / Chromebook](#)
- [iPhone / iPad](#)
- [GNU / Linux](#)

Critical Concepts

- The VPN only needs to be installed if you need access to [Trusted Resources](#).
- You will need your Active Directory (AD) username and password. If you don't remember your AD username or password, you can either reset it at [password.ucsd.edu](#) or contact your [department's systems administrator](#).
 - Your AD username is usually the first part of your UCSD email address (before @ucsd.edu).

- If you are required to comply with the [Secure Connect](#) mandate, you will be required to have Trellix (aka FireEye) Endpoint Security (HX) and Qualys Cloud Agent installed on your device. If you do not already have these software installed, you will be redirected to the installation instructions during the VPN installation process. For more information about Trellix and Qualys, please visit [Required Software](#).

Two-Step Login

- Two-step login is required for everyone when connecting to the VPN. Information for registering for Duo Two-Step can be found on the [Register for Two-Step Login \(Duo\)](#) article.
- Those required to comply with [Secure Connect NAC](#) must select a **secure-connect** group.
- Using a passcode or an alternative method to perform two-step login requires a little bit of extra typing to get it to work as expected. If you are using two-step login on the VPN for the first time, we highly recommend reviewing the instructions on [Duo Two-Step on VPN knowledge article](#).

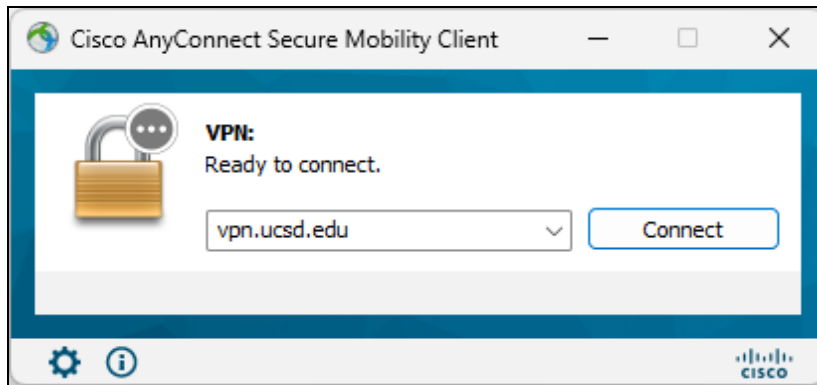
Steps to take

Windows 11 / 10

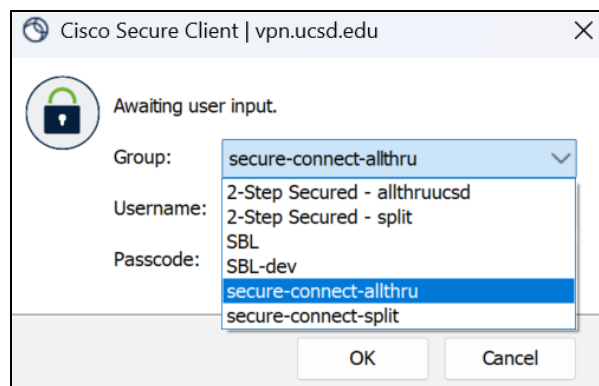
Before you begin: You must log into your computer with administrator rights.

1. [Download](#) the corresponding Cisco Secure Client for your Windows version. This will be the file with the name that ends in "core-vpn-predeploy-k9". then click **Run**.
 - NOTE: If you encounter any issues accessing this Sharepoint link, please try logging into mcvpn.ucsd.edu to access the download link titled **Windows Client Download**.
 - If you are unsure if your device is a Windows-on-Arm device, navigate to your system's **Settings > System > About**. Under "Device Specifications" > "System type", it will say "ARM-based processor" if your device is a Windows-on-Arm device.
2. Install the Cisco Secure Client:
 - a. Click **Next** to begin the installation.
 - b. Accept the terms, and click **Next**.
 - c. Click **Install**.
 - d. You may be asked if you want to allow the following program to install software on this computer - Click **Yes**.
 - e. Click **Finish**.
3. If you are not a paid employee or are not being enforced as part of the [Secure Connect](#) project on the VPN, skip to step 6.
 - a. If you are unsure if you are being enforced, see [Secure Connect Timelines and Updates](#) for the Secure Connect VPN rollout timeline.
4. [Download](#) the VPN Cisco Secure Client - ISE Posture module. This will be the file name that ends in "iseposture-predeploy-k9".
5. Install the Cisco Secure Client - ISE Posture Module:
 - a. Click **Next** to begin the installation.
 - b. Accept the terms, and click **Next**.
 - c. Click **Install**.

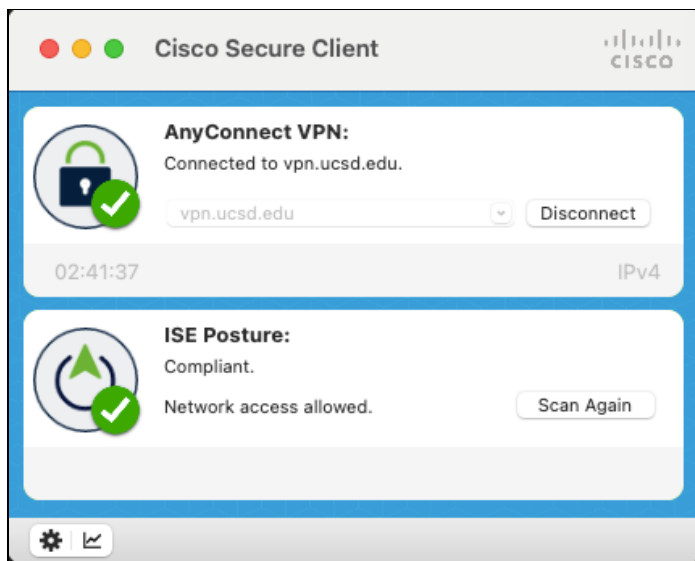
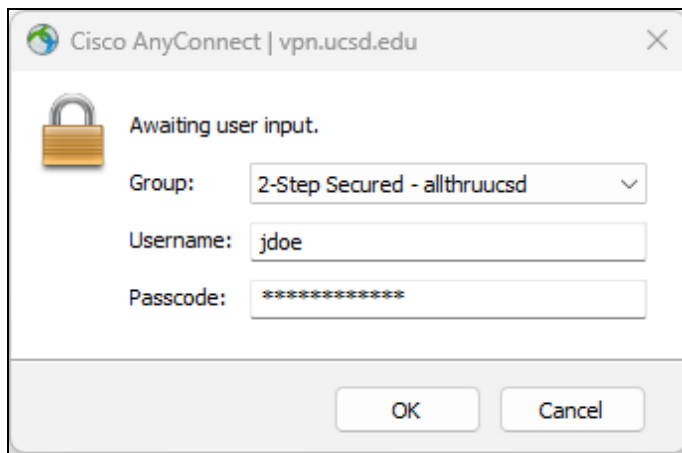
- d. You may be asked if you want to allow the following program to install software on this computer - Click **Yes**.
- e. Click **Finish**.
6. Run the Cisco Secure Client.
 - o Click on the **Windows Start Button** (this will display the Windows Start Menu). Click on **All Apps** and choose the **Cisco** folder.
7. In the first window, enter **vpn.ucsd.edu** in the box and click on the **Connect** button to the right.



8. A second window will appear. Select your desired connection profile from the **Group** drop-down menu:
 - o **2-Step Secured** options:
 - **split** - Route only campus traffic through the UCSD VPN. All other traffic goes through your normal Internet provider.
 - **allthruucsd** - Route all traffic through the UCSD VPN.
 - Use this option when accessing the CMS.
 - o **secure-connect** options - **Needs to be used if you are required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.**
 - **split** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - split" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.
 - **allthruucsd** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - allthruucsd" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.



9. Enter your **Active Directory** username and password. For Duo Two-Step, please stop here and review [how to use two-step on the VPN](#).
10. Click **Ok**.

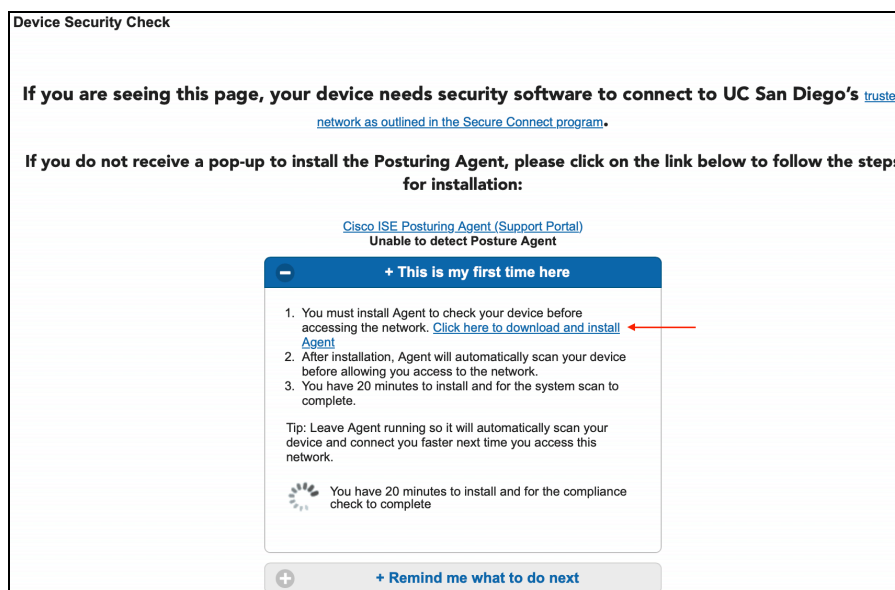


11. Next, navigate to "captive-portal.ucsd.edu". If you are required to comply with Secure Connect enforcement on the VPN, this page will say "UC San Diego VPN Security" at the top. If you do not see this, or already have the Posturing Agent (ISE Posture Module) installed, please skip to step 17.

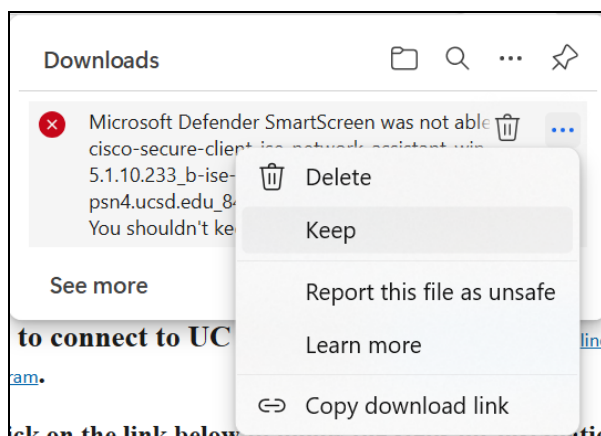
12. On the page that appears, click "Start". Then click on the "This is my first time here" dropdown menu.

13. Under step 1, click on the "Click here to download and install Agent" link. This will download the required module to your device.

O

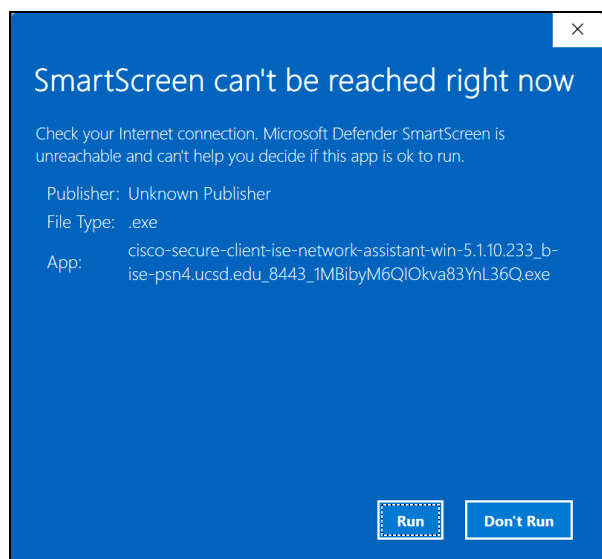


14. You may get an error when downloading the module. If so, hover the mouse over the download, click the 3 dots, and click "Keep"



15. When the module finishes downloading, click on the download to initiate the installation of the module.

1. If you get the error "SmartScreen can't be reached right now", click "Run", then click "Yes".



16. In the window that appears, click "Connect". Once the installation finishes, click "Quit".

1. You can now close out the "captive-portal.ucsd.edu" website.

17. If the device does not have all of the required software for connecting to the VPN, you will be redirected to articles on how to become compliant.

1. If you are not already logged into the "Services & Support" website, you will then need to use your Active Directory (AD) credentials to log in and access the articles.
2. Follow the steps in the articles to download and install the required software.
3. Once your device has all of the required software, the ISE Posture module should automatically re-scan your device to check again for compliancy.

1. If the module does not automatically re-scan your device, you can click the "Scan Again" button in the VPN client under "ISE Posture" to re-run the scan.

18. To disconnect from the VPN after your session is finished:

1. Click on the **Windows Start Button** (this will display the Windows Start Menu). Click on All Apps and choose the **Cisco Secure Client**.
2. When the window appears, click on the **Disconnect** button.

macOS

You must log into your computer with administrator rights.

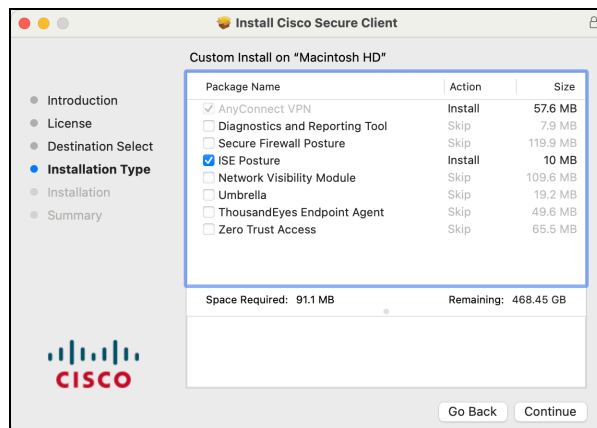
Computer must be running macOS 14 and above to use the Cisco Secure Client. Older Mac operating systems are no longer supported.

1. If the client was previously installed on your device, uninstall old client by following these steps (this will require a computer restart):
 - a. Go to your **Applications** folder.
 - b. Locate and double-click on the **Cisco** folder.
 - c. Double-click on **Uninstall Cisco Secure Client**.
 - d. Click **Uninstall**.
 - e. Enter your computer's administrator password.
 - f. You will then see a message saying that "Cisco Secure Client has been uninstalled".
 - Click **Close**.

- g. Restart your computer.
2. Download the VPN Cisco Secure Client.
 - o NOTE: If you encounter any issues accessing this Sharepoint link, please try logging into mcvpn.ucsd.edu to access the download link titled **MAC Client Download**.
3. After the download completes, double-click the **cisco-secure-client-macos** installation file. The installer icon shown below will appear on your desktop.



4. Run the installation package by double-clicking on the **Cisco Secure Client** package image.
5. Install the Cisco Secure Client:
 - a. Click **Continue** to begin the installation.
 - b. Click **Continue**.
 - c. When the Software License Agreement window appears, click **Agree** to accept.
 - d. Select the module options that you need:
 - a. If you are enforced as part of the Secure Connect project on the VPN, deselect all of the options except for "ISE Posture".
 - b. If you are not a paid employee or are not being enforced as part of the Secure Connect project on the VPN, deselect all of the options, including "ISE Posture".
 - c. If you are unsure if you are being enforced, see Secure Connect Timelines and Updates for the Secure Connect VPN rollout timeline

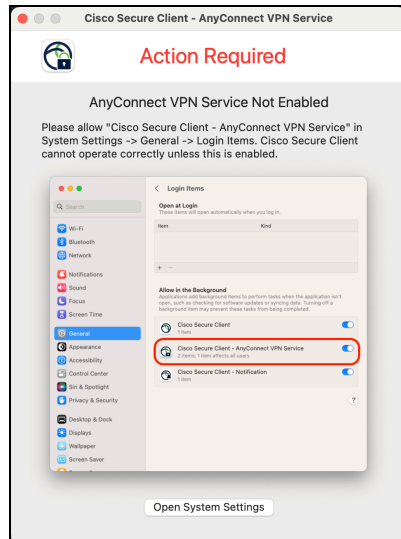


e. Click **Continue**.

f. Click **Install**.

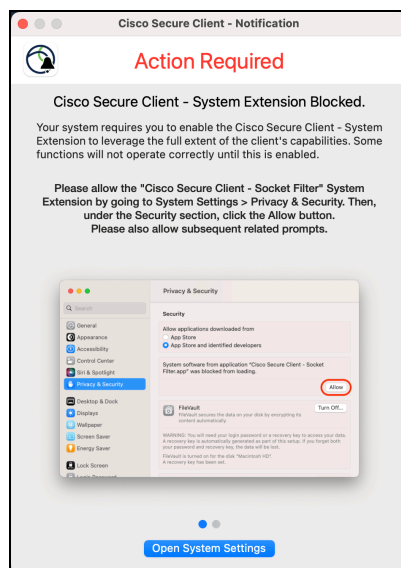
g. If prompted, enter your Administrative (system) username and password.

h. You may get the following "Action Required" pop-up . If you do, click on "Open System Settings" on the bottom of the pop-up.



i. In the Systems Settings window that appears, toggle "Cisco Secure Client - AnyConnect VPN Service" on. If prompted, enter your Administrative (system) username and password.

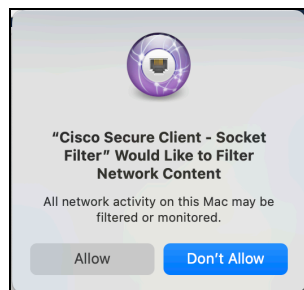
j. You may then get the following "Action Required" pop-up . If you do, click on "Open System Settings" on the bottom of the pop-up.



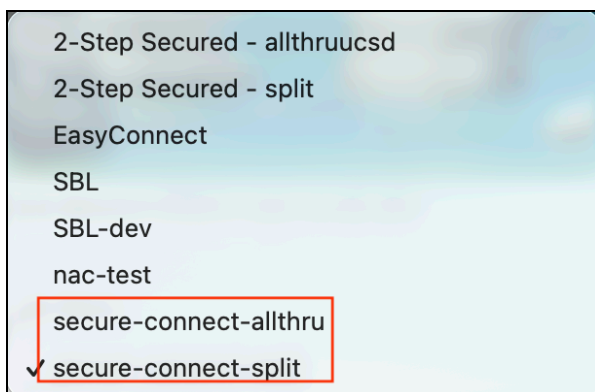
k. In the System Settings window that appears, click **Allow**.

l. When you see the "Install Succeeded" pop-up window, click **Close** to continue.

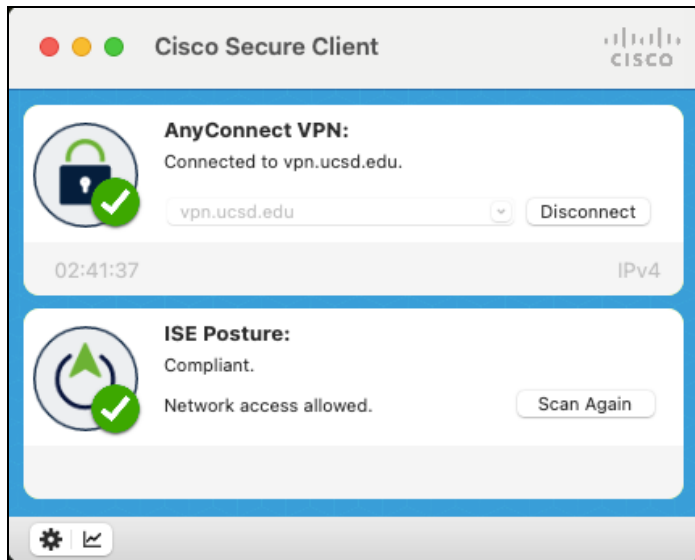
m. You may then get the following pop-up. Click **Allow**.



6. Run the Cisco Secure Client by going to the Cisco folder in Applications and double-clicking the Cisco Secure Client.
7. Enter *vpn.ucsd.edu* in the "Connect to" field.
8. Press the return (enter) key.
9. Select your desired connection profile from the **Group** drop-down menu:
 - **2-Step Secured** options:
 - **split** - Route only campus traffic through the UCSD VPN. All other traffic goes through your normal Internet provider.
 - **allthruucsd** - Route all traffic through the UCSD VPN.
 - Use this option when accessing the CMS.
 - **secure-connect** options - **Needs to be used if you are required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.**
 - **split** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - split" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.
 - **allthruucsd** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - allthruucsd" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC



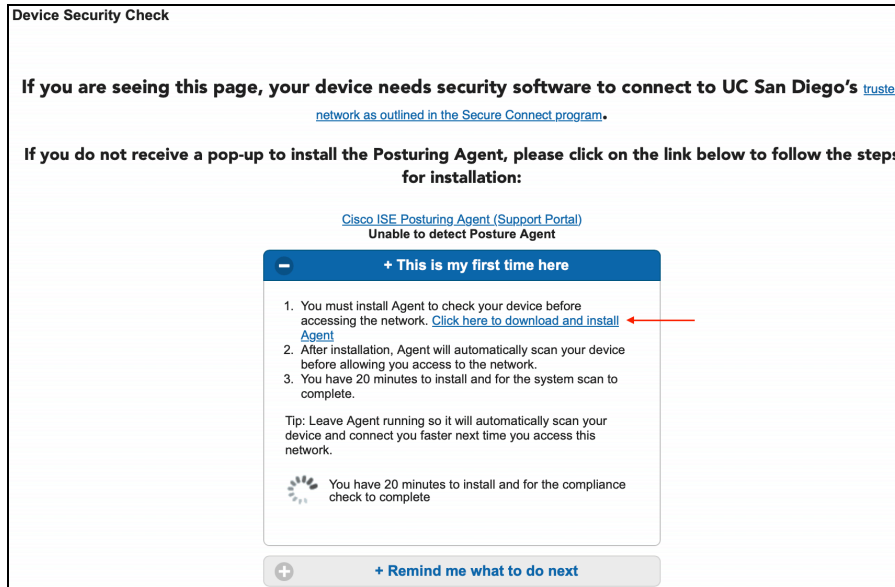
10. Enter your AD username and password. For Duo Two-Step, please stop here and review [how to use two-step on the VPN.](#)
11. Click **OK**.



12. Next, navigate to "captive-portal.ucsd.edu". If you are required to comply with Secure Connect enforcement on the VPN, this page will say "UC San Diego VPN Security" at the top. If you do not see this, or already have the Posturing Agent (ISE Posture Module) installed, skip to step 18.

13. On the page that appears, click "Start". Then click on the "This is my first time here" dropdown menu.

14. Under step 1, click on the "Click here to download and install Agent" link. This will download the required module to your device

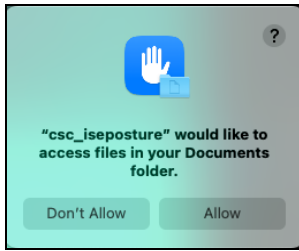


15. When the module finishes downloading, navigate to the Downloads folder and double-click on the file with the ".dmg" extension. Then double-click the "Cisco Network Setup Assistant" to initiate the installation of the module.

16. In the window that appears, click "Connect". Once the installation finishes, click "Quit".

1. You can now close out the "captive-portal.ucsd.edu" website.

17. If you encounter the following prompt or any similar prompts from "csc_iseposture", click "Don't Allow".



18. Upon connecting to one of the **secure-connect** connection profiles, a compliance module will automatically install on your device. Once this has finished installing, the ISE Posture module will evaluate your device's compliance to security standards.

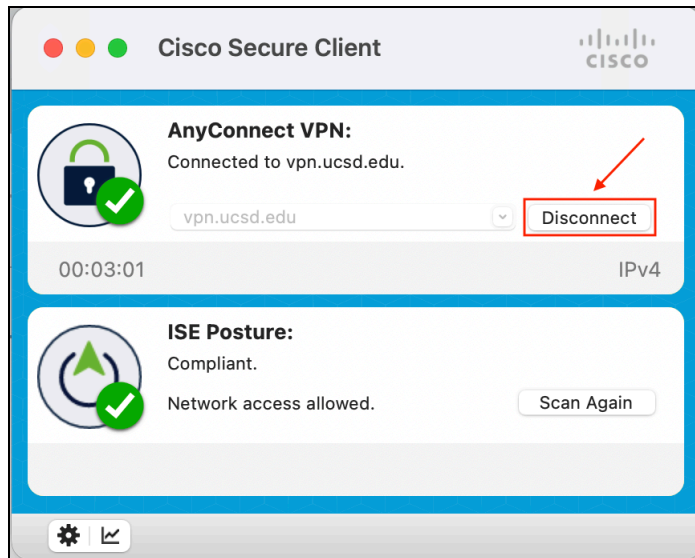
19. If the device does not have all of the required software for connecting to the VPN, you will be redirected to articles on how to become compliant.

1. If you are not already logged into the "Services & Support" website, you will then need to use your Active Directory (AD) credentials to log in and access the articles.
2. Follow the steps in the articles to download and install the required software.
3. Once your device has all of the required software, the ISE Posture module should automatically re-scan your device to check again for compliancy.

1. If the module does not automatically re-scan your device, you can click the "Scan Again" button in the VPN client under "ISE Posture" to re-run the scan.

20. To disconnect from the VPN after your session is finished:

1. Open the **Cisco Secure Client** application.
2. Click on the **Disconnect** button.



Android / Chromebook

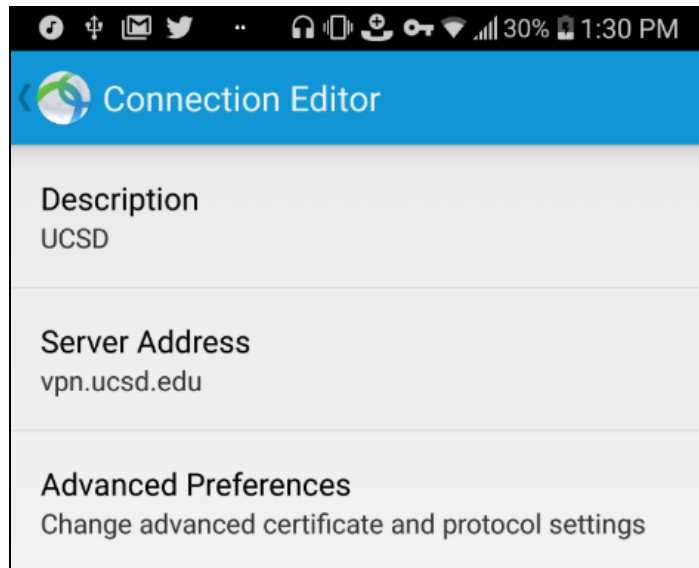
1. Open the Google Play store on your Android or Chromebook device and search for "Cisco Secure Client".

1. For Chromebooks, if you do not have the Google Play store, [follow these steps to get the Google Play store app.](#) (Note: you must be signed into a non-guest account on your Chromebook.)

2. Click **Install**.

3. Enter the VPN Connection:

- a. Open the Cisco Secure Client app.
- b. Select **Connections**.
- c. Select **Add New VPN Connection**.
- d. In Description enter: UCSD
- e. In Server Address enter: *vpn.ucsd.edu*
- f. Click **Done**.



4. On the Cisco Secure Client home screen, turn on Cisco Secure Client by selecting the Off toggle (it will change to On).

5. A second window will appear. Select your desired connection profile from the **Group** drop-down menu:

- o **2-Step Secured** options:
 - **split** - Route only campus traffic through the UCSD VPN. All other traffic goes through your normal Internet provider.
 - **allthruucsd** - Route all traffic through the UCSD VPN.
 - Use this option when accessing the CMS.

6. In the username field, enter your **Active Directory (AD)** username.

7. In the Passcode field, enter your Active Directory (AD) password. For Duo Two-Step, please stop here and review [how to use two-step on the VPN](#).

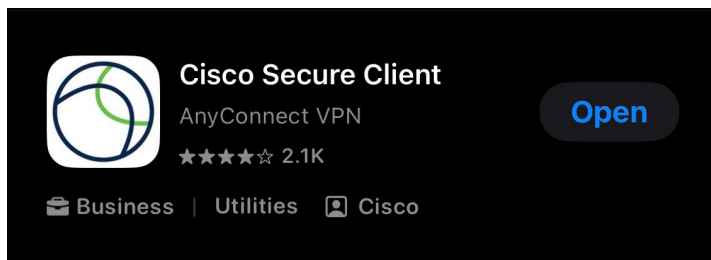
8. Click **Connect**.

9. To disconnect from the VPN after your session is finished:

- a. Open the Cisco Secure Client.
- b. On the Cisco Secure Client home screen, turn off Cisco Secure Client by clicking the On toggle (it will change to Off).

iPhone / iPad

1. Using your iPhone or iPad, download the **Cisco Secure Client** app from the App Store.

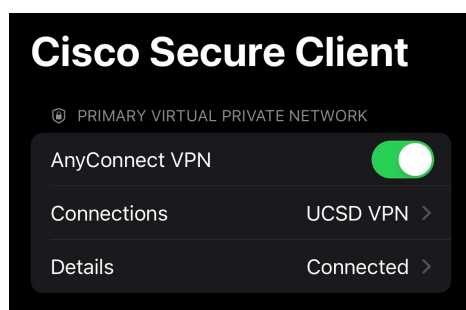


2. Add a VPN Connection:

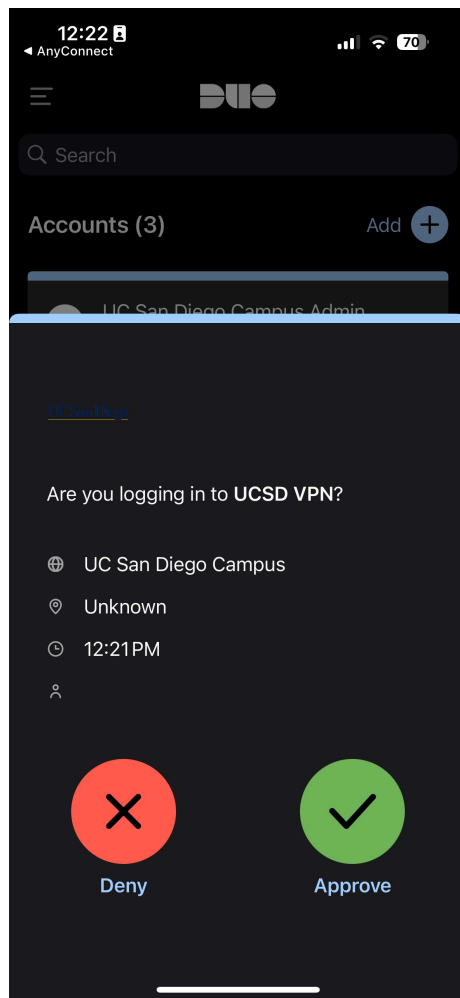
- a. Click on **Connections**.
- b. Click **Add VPN Connection**.
- c. Fill out the requested information:
 - **Description:** *UCSD VPN*
 - **Server Address:** *vpn.ucsd.edu*
- d. Click **Save**.
- e. When prompted if you would like to "Add VPN Configurations", click **Allow**.

3. Connect to the VPN:

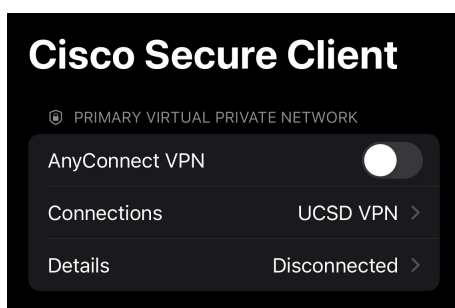
- On the main page, toggle the Cisco Secure Client VPN button to On position.



- Select your desired connection profile from the **Group** drop-down menu:
 - a. **Only use the ones labeled "2-Step Secured" or "secure-connect"**.
 - b. **2-Step Secured** options:
 - **split** - Route only campus traffic through the UCSD VPN. All other traffic goes through your normal Internet provider.
 - **allthruucsd** - Route all traffic through the UCSD VPN.
 - Use this option when accessing the CMS.
- Enter your Active Directory (AD) credentials.
- Click **Connect**.
- A Duo push will be sent to the Duo app; approve it and then return to the Cisco Secure Client app.
- Accept the connection.



4. To disconnect from the VPN after your session is finished, toggle the Cisco Secure Client VPN button to the OFF position.



Linux

Before you begin: You must either log into your computer with administrator rights or have the system root password.

Debian/Ubuntu/Linux Mint:

1. **Download** the VPN Cisco Secure Client.

1. If you have a x64-based system, choose the file named **cisco-secure-client-linux64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-deb-k9.tgz** (the version may be different).
2. If you have an ARM64-based system, choose the file named **cisco-secure-client-linux-arm64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-deb-k9.tgz** (the version may be different).
2. Open your terminal application. Navigate to the Downloads folder by typing in **cd Downloads**.
3. To decompress the archive, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **tar -xzf cisco-secure-client-linux64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-deb-k9.tgz** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 2. For ARM64-based systems: type **tar -xzf cisco-secure-client-linux-arm64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-deb-k9.tgz** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
4. To install the VPN package, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter. You may need to enter your password.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **sudo dpkg -i cisco-secure-client-vpn_5.1.16.194_amd64.deb** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 2. For ARM64-based systems: type **sudo dpkg -i cisco-secure-client-vpn_5.1.16.194_arm64.deb** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
5. If you are not a paid employee or are not being enforced as part of the [Secure Connect](#) project on the VPN, skip to the "[To use](#)" section.
 - a. If you are unsure if you are being enforced, see [Secure Connect Timelines and Updates](#) for the Secure Connect VPN rollout timeline.
6. To install the ISE posture module, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter. You may need to enter your password.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **sudo dpkg -i cisco-secure-client-iseposture_5.1.16.194_amd64.deb** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 2. ARM64-based systems: the ISE posture module is not currently supported on these systems.

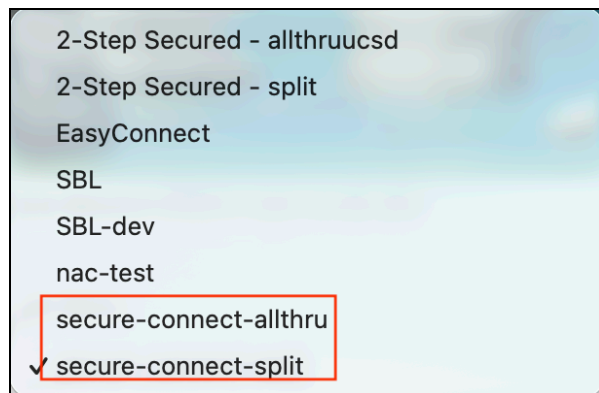
Other (e.g. Arch):

1. **Download** the VPN Cisco Secure Client.
 1. If you have a x64-based system, choose the file named **cisco-secure-client-linux64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-rpm-k9.tgz** (the version may be different).
 2. If you have an ARM64-based system, choose the file named **cisco-secure-client-linux-arm64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-rpm-k9.tgz** (the version may be different).
2. Open your terminal application. Navigate to the Downloads folder by typing in **cd Downloads**.
3. To decompress the archive, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **tar -xzf cisco-secure-client-linux64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-rpm-k9.tgz** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has

- changed).
2. For ARM64-based systems: type **tar -xzf cisco-secure-client-linux-arm64-5.1.16.194-predeploy-rpm-k9.tgz** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 4. To install the VPN package, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter. You may need to enter your password.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **sudo rpm -ivh cisco-secure-client-vpn-5.1.16.194-1.x86_64.rpm** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 2. For ARM64-based systems: type **sudo rpm -ivh cisco-secure-client-vpn-5.1.16.194-1.aarch64.rpm** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 5. If you are not a paid employee or are not being enforced as part of the [Secure Connect](#) project on the VPN, skip to the "[To use](#)" section.
 - a. If you are unsure if you are being enforced, see [Secure Connect Timelines and Updates](#) for the Secure Connect VPN rollout timeline.
 6. To install the ISE posture module, follow the instructions below for your respective system, then press enter. You may need to enter your password.
 1. For x64-based systems: type **sudo rpm -ivh cisco-secure-client-iseposture-5.1.16.194-1.x86_64.rpm** (you may need to modify the filename if the version has changed).
 2. ARM64-based systems: the ISE posture module is not currently supported on these systems.

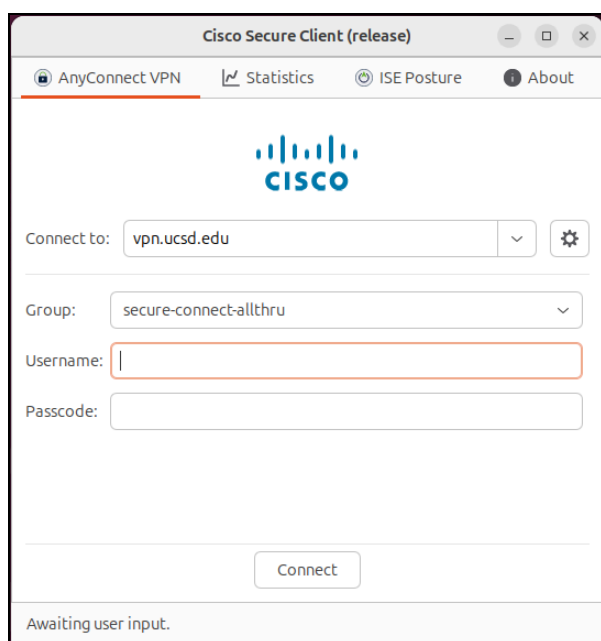
To use:

1. Run the Cisco Secure Client by searching for the application called **Cisco Secure Client**.
2. Enter **vpn.ucsd.edu** in the **Connect to** field.
3. Click **Connect**.
4. Select your desired connection profile from the **Group** drop-down menu:
 - o **2-Step Secured** options:
 - **split** - Route only campus traffic through the UCSD VPN. All other traffic goes through your normal Internet provider.
 - **allthruucsd** - Route all traffic through the UCSD VPN.
 - Use this option when accessing the CMS.
 - **secure-connect** options - **Needs to be used if you are required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.**
 - **split** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - split" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC.
 - **allthruucsd** - Similar to "2-Step Secured - allthruucsd" but for devices required to comply with Secure Connect NAC



5. Enter your **AD username** and **password**. For Duo Two-Step, please stop here and review [how to use two-step on the VPN](#).

6. Click **Connect**. If you are not required to comply with the Secure Connect NAC VPN or your VPN already shows "ISE Posture", skip to step 12.



7. You will be redirected to a page with "UC San Diego VPN Security" at the top. On this page, click "Start".

8. If you do not have the required module for your VPN instance, click on the "This is my first time here" dropdown menu.

9. Under step 1, click on the "Click here to download and install Agent" link. This will download the required module to your device.

10. When the module finishes downloading, click on the download to initiate the installation of the module.

11. In the window that appears, click "Connect". Once the installation finishes, click "Quit".

12. To disconnect from the VPN after your session is finished:

- a. Open the **Cisco Secure Client** application.
- b. Click on the **Disconnect** button.